

ODTE nearest-OTM package: per-rule return summary, pooled over the twelve entry windows 10:00–15:30 ET (daily sums), models compared on the same 866 days

	n	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	t	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe _{ann} [×]
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.160	1.338	-11.40	2.24	-1.92	8.73	3.53	1.90	-1.92
<i>sign(s) (± 1 on the sign of s)</i>										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.121	1.346	-5.96	11.40	0.27	7.23	2.64	1.43	-2.87
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.167	1.339	-6.26	11.40	0.55	7.53	3.68	1.99	-2.33
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.163	1.334	-6.26	11.40	0.59	7.57	3.59	1.94	-2.39
LightGBM [†]	866	0.158	1.341	-5.96	11.40	0.58	7.62	3.46	1.87	-2.44
XGBoost [†]	866	0.144	1.352	-5.96	11.40	0.47	7.45	3.14	1.69	-2.56
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.158	1.337	-7.03	11.40	0.30	7.98	3.47	1.87	-2.40
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.179	1.335	-6.26	10.65	0.60	6.45	3.96	2.13	-2.20
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.123	1.360	-7.03	11.40	0.26	7.79	2.67	1.44	-2.78

Each row is the daily sum over the twelve entry windows 10:00–15:30 ET: one number per expiration day, then the usual statistics on that daily series. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged. One expiration day = one return; mid fill. Every t here is the plain $t = \sqrt{n} \cdot \text{mean}/\text{std}$, with no autocorrelation correction. “ex. kurt” is the bias-corrected sample excess kurtosis (Gaussian = 0). The short-volatility rule takes no forecast, so it is one row for all models. Sharpe_{ann} = (mean/std) $\times \sqrt{252}$; every other column is daily. The one column this table adds to the deck’s is Sharpe_{ann}[×], the same rule’s annualized Sharpe at the *crossed spread* instead of the midpoint; every other column is the deck’s.

Forecasts: baseline (HAR + calendar OLS); block-diagonal ridge (HAR block and exogenous block, separate penalties) on the design carrying the FOMC calendar block, and the same ridge on the earlier design without those columns, as a diagnostic row; LightGBM and XGBoost on the all-features design; lasso on the same design, causally tuned vs. fixed $\alpha = 10^{-4}$; elastic net (causally tuned). [†] marks a column still fitted on the earlier design panel; a run of those four on the panel of record is pending. The signal is $s_t = \widehat{RV}_t - IV_{\text{hr}}^2 h_t w_t$: the forecast against the implied variance of the same window. On the bars whose vendor implied volatility is a censored solver node the deck’s treatment is used here too — the volatility that reproduces the package midpoint, recovered by bisection over the remaining h_t hours — so every bar carries a signal and no bar sits flat.